

The thought you don't write down is the one that *mattered*

There is no shortage of places to put a sentence. There is a shortage of places where the cost of putting it there is zero — and the sentences people most need to release are exactly the ones with a cost attached.

SAY IT TO A PERSON

Costs a relationship's worth of judgement. The reason it was unsaid in the first place is usually **a person**.

TYPE IT INTO AN APP

Journals, notes, cloud drives. Readable by the vendor, subpoenaable, and one account breach from being somebody else's file.

TELL IT TO AN AI

The most honest place many people already have — and every word of it arrives on a server in plaintext, attached to an identity, retained.

- › The behaviour already exists without a product: people **send themselves voice notes to think**, keep private journals, and use AI chat for things they would not say to a friend.
- › Every existing outlet fails on the same axis — **somebody else can read it** — so the hardest material never gets recorded at all.
- › Self-censorship is invisible in analytics. A product can look healthy while the thing it exists for is **silently not happening**.

TAKEAWAY The blocker isn't "nowhere to write." It's that everywhere to write is somewhere it can be read.

One invariant, enforced in code rather than promised in a policy

Unsaid is a private vault for voice and text, with optional AI reflection. Every architectural decision in the repository descends from a single rule.

thought → AES-GCM-256, fresh key per thought → ciphertext → object storage | wrapped key → Postgres

Plaintext emotional content never crosses the backend boundary. The API receives ciphertext, wrapped keys and byte counts. There is no column in the schema that can hold a thought, and no log statement that can print one.

- ✓ **Enforced, not asserted.** CI fails on a content-shaped column; log serializers strip bodies wholesale; analytics events are a closed strict union.
- ✓ **Forget beats delete.** Destroying the wrapped key first leaves a surviving backup of the ciphertext undecryptable.
- ✓ **A forgotten passphrase is survivable.** The vault key is wrapped twice — passphrase and recovery kit — so a change re-wraps one key and rewrites no ciphertext.
- ✓ **Echo is consent-gated.** AI reflection sends one specific memory, once, after the user reads what that means. Consent is checked *per version of the wording*, not as a boolean.
- ✓ **Cost is bounded.** Echo carries a rolling seven-day budget per user, counted from what was actually spent.
- ✓ **Solana is optional and content-free.** On-chain: SHA-256(thought_id || ciphertext_hash) + owner + timestamp. Never connect a wallet and the vault works fully.

TAKEAWAY The product isn't encryption. It's a promise narrow enough that the test suite can check it every time someone pushes.

Not a feasibility question any more – it's built

The MVP exists and its hardest claims are covered by integration tests running against real Postgres and real S3-compatible storage, not mocks.

17,225 LINES OF TYPESCRIPT	161 TESTS, 18 SUITES	0 CANARY HITS IN DB, LOGS, OBJECTS	1 RESTORE DRILL PASSED, 31 AUG 2026
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PROVEN IN THIS IMPLEMENTATION

- ✓ A plaintext canary written through the browser appears in **zero** of: API logs, web logs, a full pg_dump, and the raw stored objects.
- ✓ A vault written under one passphrase, that passphrase discarded, **restored from the recovery kit alone** and re-locked — end to end.
- ✓ Full capture → save → open → delete → forget cycle, plus IDOR and consent-gate tests.
- ✓ The Anchor program compiles to BPF; the client builds a real signable transaction.

HONESTLY NOT DONE

- ✗ **Production deploy.** Config written, image builds — Supabase, R2, Fly and Vercel all need accounts.
- ✗ **Crisis numbers undialled.** Every region carries verifiedOn: null deliberately; that flag is the launch gate.
- ✗ **Legal review.** Nepal Privacy Act 2075 review required before launch.
- ✗ **On-chain deploy, wallet-extension path, mobile, independent security review.**

TAKEAWAY What remains between here and a pilot is accounts, a lawyer and a phone call — not engineering risk.

Every axis is covered. The *intersection* is empty.

Encrypted notes exist. Voice capture exists. AI reflection exists. No shipping product puts all three behind one invariant — which is the opportunity and, precisely, the fragility.

PRODUCT	VENDOR CAN'T READ CONTENT	VOICE-FIRST CAPTURE	AI REFLECTION	IRREVERSIBLE FORGET	PROOF OF AUTHORSHIP
Unsaid	yes, by schema	yes	consent-gated	key destroyed	optional, on-chain
Day One	opt-in E2EE	attachment	prompts only	soft delete	—
Standard Notes	yes	—	—	—	—
Apple Notes / Voice Memos	device-bound	separate app	—	—	—
ChatGPT / Claude	no — plaintext	yes	best in class	retention policy	—
Wysa / Youper	no — server-side	partial	clinical framing	—	—
Obsidian, local vault	yes, self-hosted	—	—	manual	—

WHERE THE DEFENSIBILITY ACTUALLY IS

Not the cryptography — AES-GCM and AES-KW are commodity. It is that the invariant is **structural**: no content column to regress into, an enforcement suite in CI, and a business model that never needs the plaintext. An incumbent bolting on E2EE has to give up the data it already monetises.

Capability read as of September 2026, from public product documentation; treat each cell as a summary, not a contractual claim.

THE COMPETITIVE RISK, STATED PLAINLY

Apple ships Advanced Data Protection. Day One ships E2EE. If a well-resourced incumbent decides voice-first private reflection is a feature, **the feature gap closes in a quarter**. The window is habit and trust, not technology.

TAKEAWAY Nobody owns the intersection today — and nothing but our own speed stops someone from taking it.

Six things people believe about this that aren't true

Each one, left unanswered, costs either a signup or a lawsuit.

"It's a diary on a blockchain."

It isn't. What goes on chain is a **hash, an owner key and a timestamp** — irreversible and content-free. Anchoring is opt-in; a user who never connects a wallet has a fully working vault and no on-chain presence.

"Forget the passphrase, lose everything."

The vault key is wrapped twice, so losing the phrase costs **a re-lock, not a vault**. Lose the phrase *and* the recovery kit and it is genuinely gone — which invitees are told before they start, not after.

"End-to-end encrypted means unbreakable."

No. A **compromised device reads what you type before it is ever encrypted**. The claim is deliberately bounded: a leak of the database or object store exposes what nobody wrote — nothing more, and we say so.

"It's a mental-health product."

Not therapy, not a crisis service, not diagnostic. Crisis routing exists only to **hand off to a real number** — and the product will not launch in a region whose number a human hasn't dialled.

"The AI will train on my feelings."

Echo is off by default and ships with a stub provider that makes **no network call at all**. When enabled it sends one memory, once, after explicit consent to the specific wording — bump the version, re-ask.

"Zero-knowledge means you can't measure anything."

Wrong on both sides. The funnel is measured from a **closed, strict union of events** with no content in them; a dedicated suite asserts that measuring cannot quietly become surveillance.

TAKEAWAY The privacy story only converts if it's stated with its limits attached — the overclaim is what people stop believing.

Yes technically. Gated operationally. *Unproven* commercially.

Three different questions usually get answered as one. Separated, only the third is still open — and it's the one that decides whether this ships.

RETIRED

CAN IT BE BUILT?

It is built. 161 tests, integration against real infrastructure, a canary proven absent from every store, recovery proven end to end, a restore drill with a date on it.

FOUR GATES

CAN IT BE LAUNCHED?

Crisis lines dialled by a human · restore drill passed **against production** · Nepal-qualified privacy review · rollback documented with someone on call for day one.

OPEN

WILL ANYONE USE IT?

Unknown, and not knowable from here. A vault nobody opens twice is a well-engineered product with no job. The pilot is built to be able to return **no**.

PILOT NUMBER	WHAT IT ANSWERS	WORRYING BELOW
Vault created / landed	Is the passphrase wall survivable?	40%
First save / vault created	Did they get to the point?	60%
Returned within 7 days	Is there a reason to come back?	25%
Weekly releases per retained user	Habit, or demo? – the north star	2

20–30 people, recruited in three waves of ten from a narrow behavioural wedge — not friends. Ten structured conversations including at least three who stopped. After four weeks, one page: **go, iterate, or stop**.

TAKEAWAY Retention below those lines isn't a marketing problem — it means safe expression isn't being done well enough yet, and no further polish on the encryption changes that.